

PRODUCTS, PRICES AND PROOF

CityBeat Sales Guide

A short internal guide to what we sell, what the customer receives, and how to explain the value clearly.

THE ONE-LINE PITCH

CityBeat gives local businesses a searchable public presence and targeted ways to reach readers, then sends customers back to the business through website, ticket, application, and campaign links.

WHY DIRECTORY LISTINGS CAN SUPPORT LOCAL SEO

SIGNAL	WHAT CITYBEAT ADDS	WHY IT MATTERS
Public profile	A crawlable CityBeat page with the business name, category, location, description, hours, photos, and reviews.	Complete, consistent information gives search engines another source for understanding the business.
Website backlink	The public profile can link directly to the customer's website and social channels.	The link creates a third-party path for discovery and referral traffic. Links and directories can contribute to local prominence.
Local relevance	Category and city context place the business beside relevant local content and directory searches.	It reinforces what the business does and where it serves customers.
Fresh proof	Photos, reviews, offers, events, and complete business details make the profile useful to real people.	Useful, accurate information improves trust and can increase clicks even when ranking does not change.

SAY THIS

"A CityBeat listing gives your business another complete local profile and a direct link back to your website. That can support local relevance, prominence, and referral traffic, but no ethical publisher can guarantee a search ranking."

SEO source: Google says local results are mainly based on relevance, distance, and prominence; complete information and websites linking to a business can help. [Google Business Profile guidance](#).

BILLING KEY

RECURRING	ONE-TIME
Basic Free has no card or charge. Paid Directory plans, Newsletter Sponsorship, and Category Banner renew through Stripe until canceled.	Sponsored Story, Featured Event, 30-Day Job Posting, and approved custom quote. One charge; no automatic renewal.

DIRECTORY PRODUCTS

Sell the business presence first

Every business can start with a public claimable page. Paid plans add richer tools and visibility; Founding is limited to the first 100 paid claimers.

PRODUCT	PRICE	CUSTOMER GETS	BEST FIT
Basic Free	\$0 No card	A public, claimable CityBeat listing with no payment link or recurring charge.	Business that needs a credible starting presence now and may upgrade later.
Founding Annual	\$99 / yr \$8.25/mo effective	All Premium features at the lowest published rate, locked while the subscription stays active.	Owner ready to commit for a year; best value if a Founding spot remains.
Founding Monthly	\$9.99 / mo	All Premium features with the Founding launch rate locked while active.	Owner who wants the lowest monthly entry and a Founding spot remains.
Premium Annual	\$199 / yr \$16.58/mo effective	Photos, cover image, description, website/social links, hours, priority placement, leads, deals, and owner tools.	Stable business that wants Premium and two months of value versus monthly billing.
Premium Monthly	\$19.99 / mo	The full Premium business profile and owner growth tools with flexible monthly billing.	Most businesses starting paid local visibility without a yearly commitment.
Featured Monthly	\$49 / mo	Everything in Premium plus top-of-category placement, Featured badge, and homepage rotation.	Business that needs to stand out immediately in a competitive category.

FOUNDING 100 RULE

Never promise availability. Select Founding in the Sales Desk and let checkout confirm the cap. The locked rate lasts only while that subscription remains active.

REFERRAL PROMOTION

A PAID LISTING CAN EARN AUTOMATIC DISCOUNTS

Each paid listing receives a personalized referral link. When a referred customer remains paid and active for three calendar months, the referrer earns three discount months at 25% off. Maximum: 16 qualified referrals per listing per calendar year. Annual plans receive the equivalent value on renewal.

FAST RECOMMENDATION

CUSTOMER SAYS	RECOMMEND
"I want the best long-term value."	Founding Annual if available; otherwise Premium Annual.
"I need flexibility."	Premium Monthly; Founding Monthly only if available.
"I need to be seen first."	Featured Monthly.
"I only want the free listing."	Basic remains free; explain what Premium adds without pressure.

Do not say: "This guarantees first place on Google," "you will receive a certain number of leads," or "Founding will always be available."

ADVERTISING, EVENTS AND JOBS

Match the product to the immediate goal

These products create targeted visibility, referral traffic, or a complete public opportunity page. Use the exact price and billing term below.

PRODUCT	PRICE	CUSTOMER GETS	WHY IT HELPS
Newsletter Sponsorship	\$50 / mo Recurring	Recurring sponsor placement in CityBeat email newsletters.	Repeated exposure in a high-attention inbox. Best for brand familiarity, not a direct SEO promise.
Sponsored Story	\$30 once	One sponsored editorial-style story prepared from the customer brief and reviewed before publication.	More room to explain an opening, mission, product, or offer; published content can send readers to the approved destination.
Category Banner	\$25 / mo Recurring	Recurring banner placement beside a relevant CityBeat category.	Reaches readers while they are already exploring the subject; paid links are treated as advertising.
Featured Event	\$25 once	One enhanced event listing with featured placement after staff review.	Adds urgency, discovery, ticket information, and an event destination link.
30-Day Job Posting	\$50 once	One complete local job listing published for 30 days after staff review.	Reaches local candidates with pay, benefits, qualifications, and a direct application path.
Custom One-Time Quote	Approved amount	A manager-approved CityBeat product with exact deliverables written into the order.	Keeps a negotiated package inside the same secure payment and fulfillment workflow.

GOAL TO PRODUCT

GOAL	BEST START
Build an ongoing local presence and website pathway	Paid Directory
Own the top position in a directory category	Featured Directory
Stay visible in readers' inboxes	Newsletter Sponsorship
Explain a story, launch, mission, or offer	Sponsored Story
Reach category-specific readers repeatedly	Category Banner
Increase event discovery and ticket clicks	Featured Event
Hire local candidates	30-Day Job Posting
Sell a negotiated package	Manager-approved Custom Quote

PAID LINKS AND SEO

Advertising links can drive qualified referral traffic, but paid placements should not be sold as an organic ranking shortcut. Lead with audience fit, visibility, and a clear destination.

SIMPLE SALES CONVERSATION

Ask. Match. Explain. Close.

Short language is easier to understand and harder to misstate.

STEP	CLICK / ENTER	RESULT
1	Ask the goal	"Do you need ongoing visibility, a campaign, event attendance, or local applicants?"
2	Match one product	Recommend the smallest product that directly addresses the goal.
3	State the exact offer	Say the product, deliverable, price, and whether it renews.
4	Explain the next step	Free creates a claimable listing with no card. Paid products use Stripe, then the product brief.
5	Create the handoffs	Free shows the Listing link only. A paid new listing shows separate Payment and Listing links.
6	Confirm the handoff	Send the correct links; check paid order, brief, and fulfillment status in the Sales Desk.

CLOSE LANGUAGE

RECOMMENDED

"Based on your goal, I recommend [product] for [exact price and term]. Basic Free needs no card; I create the listing and send its claim link. Paid products use a private Stripe link, followed by the fulfillment brief."

TRUTH CHECK

SAY	NEVER PROMISE
Crawlable profile, website link, local relevance, targeted visibility, referral traffic, clear deliverables, and reporting.	A specific Google rank, guaranteed leads or sales, unapproved discounts, instant publication, refunds, or Founding availability.

PAYMENT SAFETY

Never collect or type a customer's card number. Stripe hosts checkout. Subscriptions save the payment method and renew automatically until canceled; one-time products do not renew.

Start a sale: <https://citybeatmag.co/en/admin/sales/new>

Use the live Sales Desk as the final authority for availability, price, billing cadence, order status, discounts, and commission.